

TABLETS

Ever wonder what to look for when buying a tablet besides the budget and screen size? Let us enlighten you

By **Hardik Singh**

Handheld devices are surpassing each other at a very rapid pace in terms of performance, yet they aren't powerful enough to outmanoeuvre laptops and PCs in terms of performance and productivity. Enter the in-betweeners – tablets. While tablets are also not powerful enough to match high performance laptops and PCs, they can certainly outmatch netbooks with ease. Currently, tablets are available in many forms, sizes and prices. While the lower end of the tablet segment is primarily aimed at users buying a media consumption device, higher end tablets deliver on the productivity front as well.

So, how do you go about buying a tablet that meets your requirements? What configuration would suffice your needs? What screen size would you favour? And what about the quality of the display? We've structured a buying guide that should help you figure all this out. You can use the quick hands-on test outlined here on the tablet in the electronic store itself for a fair idea about whether the tablet is worth buying. We've also included a number of tests we ourselves run when we test tablets here in our test labs. You can run these tests on your newly bought tablets to quantify the different components of your tablet.

Display

Besides different displays sizes, tablets can also be classified based on their varied

display types and display resolutions. Once you've assessed your purpose for wanting a tablet, you can then proceed to check whether your favourable display size and resolution is available in the market.

Display size of a tablet corresponds directly to its portability. Screen sizes also determine the size and weight of the device. A larger screen size generally means a heavier tablet. For example, if you need a tablet to check email, read ebooks and catch an occasional movie, a light 7-inch portable tablet can easily serve the purpose. However, if you're looking for a replacement to your laptop, a tablet such as the 12-inch display Microsoft Surface Pro would do the job. Its display

size makes it unfit to be considered for the portable category. However, what you lose on portability, you gain in productivity.

Voice and Data

Another major sought after feature these days is voice calling. This feature can enable you to ditch your smartphone completely. Since most voice tablets offer a larger battery and a larger display to carry out tasks far more easily than on a mobile phone, choosing to use only a tablet makes sense.

In the ever growing need of staying connected, having data capabilities in a tablet comes in very handy. Be it socialising via social media or web calling via Skype, having a data plan is a bigger requirement than voice calling. However, there are users who are satisfied with just Wi-Fi and that's understandable if your lower budget is the reason for that decision.

OS

An operating system is a very subjective choice. If you're merely looking for a media consumption device and don't want to spend a fortune buying a tablet, you can easily opt for Android. If you want to be a bit more productive and require a somewhat similar experience to what you get from a PC, then the OS of choice is certainly Windows. Keep in mind, however, that Windows on tablets is still very choppy but we hope that the problem will be solved with the upcoming



Is a larger tablet better than a smaller one?